

Gimbalabs | VESPR - Cardano Onboarding Workshop

Guideline: Regional Discussions Executive Summary (For Public Review and Comment)

Attendees

The meeting brought together community members from across the global Cardano ecosystem:

- United States: Newman and Jame (Gimbalabs), Seungheon(IO)
- Singapore: Jingles, TW (Mesh)
- Argentina: Jose, Rodrigo (Cardano Ambassador)
- Portugal: Lucas (45B)
- Taiwan: Sabrina, Leo, and Jeremy(Ex-CF)
- Canada: Damian and Eric (BigLazyCat)
- Japan: Akyo(SPO)
- Hong Kong: Hinson, Anson, Neal (DeltaDeFi/SIDAN)
- Romania: Vlad and Cosmin (Vesper)

Meeting Objective: Hosted by Neal, this meeting brought together community builders from the United States, Singapore, Argentina, Portugal, Taiwan, Canada, Japan, Hong Kong, and Romania. The primary goal was to **gather global perspectives to create a universally applicable "Cardano Onboarding Playbook"** that helps beginners smoothly enter and remain in the ecosystem.

Key Point 1: Redefining the Target Audience & "Value Proposition"

- **Differentiating "End-Users" and "Builders":** In the early stages of onboarding, it is crucial to distinguish between end-users who simply use Web3 products and developers who build them. The general public (end-users) does not need complex developer skills or an understanding of underlying technologies.
- **Addressing Real User Needs (The "Main Course" vs. "Side Dish"):** Promotion currently faces an urgent crisis of a lacking value proposition. The public is losing interest in "what real-world problems blockchain can solve" and primarily cares about functionality and making money. Promotion should focus on positive growth momentum and staking yields, rather than technical details like Plutus or Haskell.
- **The Perfect "Bank" Analogy:** Just as people use banks without understanding the backend operations, users only care about fees, transaction speeds, and yields. The core value proposition should simply be: "Cardano is better than your bank".
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Key Point 2: Regional Market Profiles & Promotion Pain Points

- **Hong Kong:** The strategy has shifted from early developer recruitment to building public awareness and **actively engaging with traditional financial institutions to bridge institutional capital into Cardano**. They also focus on providing internship and networking opportunities for students.
- **Eastern Europe (Romania):** Users heavily prioritize cost and efficiency. The primary task is to **provide a fast, frictionless wallet creation experience**, use plain language for communication, and flag high-risk tokens to build a sense of security and trust.
- **Taiwan:** The target audience consists of 20-40-year-old professionals and students with moderate to high tech backgrounds, whose primary motivation is **earning stable ADA staking rewards**. Taiwanese users are more pragmatic, preferring low-risk, steady returns. The main pain points are the high barrier of transitioning from Web2 to Web3, the deep-rooted "scam" stigma of cryptocurrency, and a severe lack of in-depth localized Chinese information.

Key Point 3: Workshop Core Curriculum Planning (Priorities)

The meeting proposed a six-topic workshop: Introduction to Blockchain, Staking and Delegation, Governance, Ecosystem dApps, Wallet Operations, and Security Precautions.

- **Wallets, Staking, and Security Must Be the First Priority:** These areas are most directly related to the users' immediate interests. Governance and dApps can be explored in later stages.
- **Using "Low-Risk Activities" to Counter Scam Fears:** The public and students often immediately associate cryptocurrency with "scams" and "rug pulls". To build trust, **workshops should not start by having beginners trade high-risk tokens; instead, they should be guided to participate in safe "staking and delegation"**.
- **Implementing "Chain Abstraction":** Educational materials should focus on the "minimum necessary knowledge" and avoid excessive underlying technical details (like the complete Ouroboros mechanism), allowing Web2 users to experience Web3 seamlessly.

Key Point 4: Innovative Cross-Industry Promotion Strategies (The Portugal Experience)

Lucas shared highly effective, non-traditional promotion strategies centered around the concept of "Learn, Manage, Build":

- **Rejecting Crypto Jargon:** They **deliberately avoid words like "crypto" or "yield"**, emphasizing "Web3 utility" instead, such as digital books or concert tickets. ADA is compared to "digital terrain," and staking is framed simply as a way to offset inflation.
- **In-Person Marketing Outside the Crypto Bubble:** They avoid using X (Twitter) and focus entirely on LinkedIn, Instagram, and Facebook. The team wears Cardano t-shirts and **attends non-crypto events (e.g., digital nomad conferences, local music**

festivals, and NFT art summits), successfully connecting with local accountants, lawyers, and even regulators.

Key Point 5: User Retention & Long-Term Engagement

To prevent users from dropping off after a single introductory workshop, attendees proposed several retention mechanisms:

- **Notification Systems and Community Rituals:** Develop a subscription push system similar to the Catalyst App (Vesper wallet is also implementing in-app banner news notifications). Simultaneously, establish regular community "rituals," such as online gatherings to celebrate the end of every Epoch.
- **Specific Tasks and Incentives:** It was recommended that workshops conclude with the completion of a "first staking task," followed by a check-in one week later, providing small ADA or NFT rewards as incentives. Furthermore, exploring collaborations with university clubs can help educate the next generation and reduce the social stigma of cryptocurrency from its roots.

Next Steps:

- **Consolidate Resources:** Compile all feedback from this meeting (including recommended YouTube tutorial channels and blockchain explorer tools) into a **comprehensive "Onboarding Playbook"**, which will be open-sourced and uploaded to GitHub for global community review.
- **Trial Testing:** Host trial workshops in various regions (e.g., Taiwan) to practically test and optimize the curriculum materials.
- **Multi-Language Release:** The final version of the guideline will be translated into **English, Chinese, and Japanese** to support promotional needs across different global regions